Liyang Sun

Employment

Lecturer, University College London, Economics — September 2023 - present
Untenured Associate Professor (on leave), CEMFI, Economics — September 2023 - August 2026
Assistant Professor, CEMFI, Economics — July 2022 - August 2023
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, UC Berkeley, Economics & Statistics — July 2021 - June 2022

Affiliations

Research Staff, Centre for Microdata Methods and Practice (CeMMAP) — 2024-
Research Associate, The Institute for Fiscal Studies (IFS) — 2026-

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Ph.D., Economics & Statistics — June 2021
Wellesley College, B.A., Economics & Mathematics (Summa Cum Laude) — May 2014

Professional Activities

Fund Internship Program, IMF — 2020
Research Assistant, Shaanxi Normal University CEEE (Xi'an, China) - Stanford REAP — 2017-2018
Research Assistant to Professor Heidi Williams, NBER — 2014-2015

Publications

"Empirical Welfare Maximization with Constraints"
Journal of Econometrics (2026) 253, 106169

"Adapting to Misspecification" with Tim Armstrong and Patrick Kline
Econometrica (2025) 93(6), 1981-2005

"Using Multiple Outcomes to Improve the Synthetic Control Method" with Eli Ben-Michael and Avi Feller
Accepted at *Review of Economics and Statistics*

"Weak Identification with Many Instruments" with Anna Mikusheva
Econometrics Journal (2024) 27(2), C1-C28.

"Temporal Aggregation for the Synthetic Control Method" with Eli Ben-Michael and Avi Feller
AEA Papers & Proceedings (2024) 114: 614-17.

"Double Robustness for Complier Parameters and a Semiparametric Test for Complier Characteristics" with Rahul Singh
Econometrics Journal (2024) 27(1), 1-20.

"A linear panel model with heterogeneous coefficients and variation in exposure" with Jesse M. Shapiro
Journal of Economic Perspectives (2022) 36(4), 193-204.

"Inference with Many Weak Instruments" with Anna Mikusheva
Review of Economic Studies (2022) 89(5), 2663-2686.

"Estimating Dynamic Treatment Effects in Event Studies with Heterogeneous Treatment Effects" with Sarah Abraham
Journal of Econometrics (2021) 225(2), 175-199.

"Weak Instruments in IV Regression: Theory and Practice"

with Isaiah Andrews and James Stock
Annual Review of Economics (2019) 11, 727-753.

"Implementing Valid Two-step Identification-robust Confidence Sets for Linear Instrumental-variables Models"
Stata Journal (2018) 18(4), 803-825.

Working Papers

"Policy Learning with Confidence" with Victor Chernozhukov, Sokbae Lee and Adam M. Rosen
"Estimating Treatment Effects under Bounded Heterogeneity" with Soonwoo Kwon

Discussions

Discussion of "Augmented balancing weights as linear regression" by David Bruns-Smith, Oliver Dukes, Avi Feller, Elizabeth L Ogburn, Augmented balancing weights as linear regression, *Journal of the Royal Statistical Society Series B: Statistical Methodology*, 2025

Policy papers

"Structural Reforms and Economic Growth: A Machine Learning Approach" with Anil Ari and Gabor Pula
IMF Working Paper #2022/184

Grants and Fellowships

UCL Stone Centre Research Support Grant (£12,500, Project Lead)	2026
UKRI ESRC New Investigator Grant (£243,705, Project Lead)	2025-2027
Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation Grant (€147,000, joint with Dmitry Arkhangelsky and Siqi Wei)	2023-2025
Ayudas Juan de la Cierva Formación Grant (€60,000, early termination)	2023
Jerry A. Hausman Graduate Dissertation Fellowship, MIT ($40,000)	2019-2020
Fanny Bullock Workman Fellowship, Wellesley ($16,000)	2017-2018
MIT Department of Economics Fellowship ($64,000)	2015-2017
Wellesley College Albright Institute Fellow	2013
Wellesley in Washington Fellowship	2013
Science Center Summer Research Fellowship, Wellesley	2012
Classical Studies Department McCann Fellowship, Wellesley	2011

Honors and Award

UCL Arena Fellowship/AdvanceHE, Fellow	2025
Royal Economic Society/Econometrics Journal 2024 Denis Sargan Econometrics Prize	2025
Editor's Choice, *Econometrics Journal*	2024
Excellence in Refereeing Award, *Review of Economic Studies*	2023
Dennis Aigner prize for the best empirical paper published in the *Journal of Econometrics*	2023
Best Paper Award: Methodology, NeurIPS Workshop on ML for Economic Policy	2020
MIT School of Humanities, Arts and Social Sciences Levitan Teaching Award	2019
Summa Cum Laude, Wellesley	2014
Phi Beta Kappa, Wellesley	2014
The Natalie Bolton Economics Student Prize, Wellesley	2014
The Natalie Bolton Faculty Prize in Domestic Economics, Wellesley	2014

Teaching Experience

PhD Workshop: Topics in Econometric (Graduate), UCL	2024, 2026
Advanced Microeconometrics (Graduate), UCL	2024-
Programme Evaluation for Users (Graduate), UCL	2024-
Applied Microeconometrics (Graduate), CEMFI	2023
Inference on Causal and Structural Parameters Using ML and AI (Graduate), MIT Teaching Assistant to Professor Victor Chernozhukov	2021
Research and Communication in Economics (Undergraduate), MIT Teaching Assistant to Professor Simon Jäger	2021

Econometrics (Undergraduate), MIT 2017-2018
Teaching Assistant to Professor Anna Mikusheva
Public Finance (Graduate), MIT 2018
Teaching Assistant to Professor Amy Finkelstein

Conference Presentations

2026 ASSA Winter Meeting, Bristol Econometrics Study Group, EcoSta

2025 Emory Causal Panel Workshop, Encounters in Econometric Theory, Tinbergen Econometrics Workshop, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen, International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE), Econometrics Society World Congress, SEA, LMU-NYU Workshop on Advances in Policy Analysis, CEMFI

2024 ASSA Winter Meeting, Manchester Econometrics Workshop, Society for Economic Dynamics, Munich Econometrics Workshop, Bernoulli-IMS 11th World Congress in Probability and Statistics, SEA, $(EC)^2$, CMStatistics

2023 ASSA Winter Meeting, Econometrics Society Africa Meeting, Econometrics Society North America Summer Meeting, Munich Econometrics Workshop, The Bravo Center/JEA/SNSF Workshop on Using Data to Make Decisions, Econometrics Society European Summer Meeting, Interactions: Bringing Together Econometrics and Applied Microeconomics VIII, Stone Center at UCL Research Day, SEA, Symposium on Machine Learning for Causal Inference in the Health and Social Sciences

2022 University of Michigan Two-way Fixed Effects Workshop, California Econometrics Conference, American Causal Inference Conference, Aarhus Econometrics Workshop I, Stata Economics Virtual Symposium, Computational and Methodological Statistics (CMStatistics)

2021 ASSA Winter Meeting, Econometrics Jamboree, Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting

2020 Women in Data Science (WiDS) Cambridge, Econometrics Society World Congress, National Association for Business Economics (NABE) Tech Economics Conference. NeurIPS Workshop on ML for Economic Policy, Econometric Society European Winter Meeting

2019 NeurIPS CausalML Workshop

Conference Discussions

2026 Peter Hull (Elsevier Editor-in-Chief Face-to-Face Meeting)

2025 Christophe Gaillac (Munich Econometrics Workshop)

2024 Tim Armstrong (ASSA Winter Meeting), Dalia Ghanem, Désiré Kédagni and Ismael Mourifié (NBER Summer Institute Labor Studies)

Seminar Presentations

2026 Harvard/MIT, National University of Singapore, Nanyang Technological University, Singapore Management University, University of Rochester, University of Bologna

2025 University of Geneva, Tilburg University, University of Chicago, Goethe University Frankfurt, University of Glasgow Adam Smith Business School, UC Berkeley - Statistics, UC Davis, Stanford University

2024 London School of Economics, Toulouse School of Economics, Groningen University, University of St.Gallen, Stanford University, University of Gothenburg, University of Cambridge, Universität Bonn, University of Pennsylvania

2023 Wellesley College, UCL, NYU, University of Warwick, University of Surrey, Universität Mannheim, University of Amsterdam, University of Exeter Business School, Chamberlain Seminar, Boston College, University of Arizona, University of Bristol, University Charles III of Madrid

2022 Georgetown University, The University of British Columbia, UC Davis, University of Cambridge, Pompeu Fabra University, University of Southern California, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, CREST-PSE, Sciences Po, LMU München - Empirical Economics

2021 Brown University, CEMFI, Cornell University, Erasmus University Rotterdam, HKUST, LMU München, Microsoft - Office of the Chief Economist, Penn State, Princeton University, Università Bocconi, Universität Bonn, Universität Mannheim, UC Berkeley - Economics, UC Irvine, University College London, UC Santa Cruz, University of Essex, UW Seattle, UW Madison, VU Amsterdam, Wellesley College

2020 UC Berkeley - Statistics

Invited Lectures

2023 Advances in DiD Workshop (University of Exeter Business School), NBER Summer Institute Methods Lecture

Organized Workshops

2025 Workshop on Applied Microeconometrics and Panel Data (CEMFI)

Professional Service

UKRI ESRC Peer Review College 2025-
Organizing Committee Member, Online Chamberlain Seminar 2025-
Program Committee Member, (EC)^2 European Conferences of the Econometrics Community 2026
Program Committee Member, International Association of Applied Econometrics 2025, 2026
Program Committee Member, Econometric Society Asian Summer Meeting 2026
Program Committee Member, Royal Economic Society Annual Conference 2024-2026
Program Committee Member, Econometric Society European Winter Meeting 2024, 2026
Scientific Committee Member, International Association of Applied Econometrics (Xiamen) 2024
Program Committee Member, Econometric Society European Summer Meeting 2022, 2023
Program Committee Member, American Causal Inference Conference 2022

Referee for

American Economic Review (5), American Economic Review: Insights (6), American Journal of Health Economics (1), American Journal of Political Science (1), Biometrika (1), Canadian Journal of Statistics (1), Econometric Theory (2), Econometrica (11), Economic Inquiry (1), Econometrics Journal (3), Econometrics Review (2), Econometrics and Statistics (1), Food Policy (1), Health Services and Outcomes Research Methodology (2), Journal of the American Statistical Association (2), Japanese Economic Review (1), Journal of Applied Econometrics (7), Journal of Business & Economic Statistics (8), Journal of Causal Inference (1), Journal of Econometrics (18), Journal of Economic Literature (1), Journal of Labor Economics (1), Journal of Machine Learning Research (1), Journal of Political Economy (6), Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics (1), Journal of Public Economics (1), Journal of the Royal Statistical Society: Series B (1), Journal of the Royal Statistical Society: Series C (1), Journal of Urban Economics (1), Labour Economics (1), Nature Human Behaviour (1), Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics (1), Political Analysis (1), Quantitative Economics (3), Quarterly Journal of Economics (5), Review of Economics and Statistics (12), Review of Economic Studies (11), Scientific Reports (1), Stata Journal (2), Statistical Science (2)

Grant application reviewer for National Science Foundation (3), Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (1)

Departmental Service

Co-organizer of the UCL Econometrics Seminar 2025-
UCL Policy Lab Economics Department Committee 2024-
UCL Junior Recruiting Committee 2024-
Faculty Coordinator (UCL) for the European Network for Training in Economic Research 2024-2026
Deputy Graduate Tutor of the UCL Economics Department 2023-2025
Co-organizer of the CEMFI Econometrics Seminar 2022-2023
Co-organizer of the CEMFI Maria the Maeztu Visitors Program 2022-2023
MIT IDSS Student Council Secretary 2019-2020
MIT Econometrics Lunch Organizer 2018-2020

Updated: August 2026